

Delaware County Council Meeting January 2nd 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=j3cvrLHbh70
Publication Date	2025-01-03T03:01:52Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council: Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: January 22, [2025]

Body: Delaware County Council (Special Meeting)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** [00:00:03](#) The special meeting of the Delaware County Council was called to order by the presiding officer. The meeting was subsequently turned over to the auditor to conduct the opening procedures.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Bookout, Mr. Langan (Dan), Mr. Hughes, Mr. M., Mr. Miller (Mel), Ms. Piper, and other council members. (Roll call confirmed a full quorum).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Initially unspecified during the opening roll, but later leadership roles were voted upon.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** [00:00:12](#) The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Brad Bookout.

- **Approval of Minutes:** 00:01:13 Upon a motion and second, a proposal was made and approved to table the council meeting minutes from December 17th until the next meeting.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Leadership Elections

- **00:02:42 Election of Council President**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Two nominations were brought forward: Mr. Whitehead (nominated by Mr. M.) and a self-nomination by the incumbent President Pro Tempore, Jessica Piper. Mr. Whitehead expressed a view that current leadership lacked 100% support from members inside and outside the building. Ms. Piper highlighted her track record of attendance, committee involvement, work on job classifications, and efforts to improve communication.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote (5-2 in favor of Mr. Whitehead; exact individual breakdown recorded on transcript roll call). Mr. Whitehead assumed the role of Council President.
 - **00:09:30 Election of President Pro Tempore**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council members.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Nominations were opened for President Pro Tempore.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Roll Call Vote.
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Financial Transfers & Appropriations

- **00:10:28 Community Corrections Grant Transfer (County General / Home Detention)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jane Miranda, Community Corrections.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to move leftover grant money from payroll lines (due to staff gaps) over to the professional line. The auditor noted adjustments to zero out the bottom line.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:13:24 Commissioners Appropriation (Longevity / Personnel)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / Auditor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation for longevity and personnel lines.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:14:33 Communications Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Communications Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Covering charges put on a credit card just before cutoff that could not be encumbered in 24, plus longevity and subscriptions.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.

- **00:16:21 EMA Educational Incentive Pay**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMA / Jessica.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Educational incentive pay for office manager Heidi, vetted and approved by the county attorney and HR.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:18:09 Sheriff / Hightech Crime & County General Appropriations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff's Department / Auditor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion arose regarding discrepancies between advertised appropriations and requested amounts (\$236,000 vs. proposed higher totals including High-Tech Crimes unit and longevity). After calculating figures, it was decided to withdraw the High-Tech Crimes unit portion (\$9,152.88) and reduce the longevity line to \$26,000 to match the advertised amount, deferring the remainder to the next regular meeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved with reductions/withdrawals by Roll Call Vote. (Major transfer tied to this was also withdrawn for re-typing/re-advertising).
- **00:27:33 Jail Appropriation (Longevity)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation for longevity experience pay (\$38,000).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:28:33 Court / Prosecutor Commission Longevity Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Court / Prosecutor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Standard longevity experience pay line item.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:29:34 4D Court Appropriation & FICA/PERF**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** 4D Court.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Covers longevity and associated FICA/PERF to secure 66% federal reimbursement.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:30:34 Prosecutor Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Prosecutor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Longevity experience pay appropriation (\$83,000).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:31:10 Family Support Division Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Family Support Division.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Longevity experience pay (\$10,000).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
- **00:31:52 Statewide 911 Equipment Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** 911 / Communications.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$62,000 for equipment to add two channel paths onto the radio tower. This addresses a bottleneck identified during the recent tornado event.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
 - **00:33:05 Operation Pullover Grant Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff / Law Enforcement.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Grant appropriation of \$135,300 for operation pullovers (reimbursed monthly by the federal government).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
 - **00:36:06 SPO Fund Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** SPO Program.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual appropriation (\$6,000 for office supplies, \$6,000 for communications) funded by fees collected from offenders.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
 - **00:37:16 Prosecutor LIT Appropriation & Part-Time Staffing**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Lisa Car (Prosecutor's Office).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to transfer/appropriate funds because a receptionist position was vacant on medical leave, and part-time coverage started late December. Unspent funds from November were returned, and this re-appropriates funds for LIT longevity and part-time lines.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
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Board Appointments & Committee Reports

- **00:40:18 Council Liaison Assignments**
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed and assigned liaisons for various boards and committees for the upcoming year (covering Commissioners, Housing Authority, Transportation, Highway Department, Libraries, Wastewater, Security, Finance, Job Classification, Health, Fairboard, Animal Control, and Redevelopment Commission). Clarifications were made regarding the Emergency Management Advisory Council (EMAC) representation.
 - **00:42:57 Housing Authority Board Appointment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Presiding Officer.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council considered applicants for the Housing Authority board. Tim Pierce, CEO of Crane Trust Federal Credit Union, applied, filling a desired background need in banking/finance as recommended previously by citizen Forse Bowers.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Roll Call Vote.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:43:33 Christopher Bilbury:** Submitted an email question asking whether Brad Bookout will continue having his contract with the county while sitting as a council

member.

- *Council Response:* Addressed briefly by the council, noting awareness of the Delaware County contract and that Mr. Bookout continues in that capacity.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **00:49:23 Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Council members thanked outgoing and incoming leadership.
 - A moment of reflection was held for communities impacted by recent incidents in Vegas/Orleans.
- **00:49:52 Adjournment:**
 - Motion to adjourn made by Dan, seconded by Jessica. Passed by Roll Call Vote.
 - **Next Meeting:** January 28th at 9:00 AM at the regular meeting location.

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